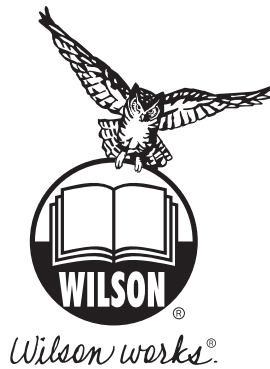


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A Book of Legends

Students in the eighth grade at Rice School had to write their own made-up legend for a school project. All the students were thrilled about the task. The tales would be collected and published to share with others.

One of the best crafted legends was about a magic dragon called Bruce who made his home in the middle of a lively city. Although he was gigantic and reptile-like, Bruce was a gentle animal. During the day, Bruce wore a huge hat and fancy cape to hide his evil-looking face and bat-like wings. He longed to fit in with the citizens of the city, and he was sure that his friendly costume did the trick. This silly and inventive legend gave everyone a good laugh.

Another student presented a legend about a princess called Cindy the Excellent. It had been predicted that someday this graceful baby would be able to solve the most difficult riddles and provide necessary answers to the most demanding problems.

Cindy spent her days as a child in a stone castle on an especially large hill. When Cindy became an adult princess, people traveled for days just to ask her for advice. Will I have success on my new cycle, Cindy? What is the best price for this gem, Cindy? Except, this princess could never decide how to answer any of these puzzles. Time after time, she responded, “My, my. I do not know!” Everyone was a fan of this tale about an excellent princess who was unable to solve a single trouble. Do you have your own tale to tell?

Nigel and the Cisco Bike Shop PART ONE

Nigel has a job at an especially successful cycle shop in San Francisco. He began working at Cisco Bike Shop part-time when he was in the tenth grade. Now Nigel is an adult and, thankfully, still loves his job. After all these years, Nigel loves coming into the shop every day and helping people find an excellent cycle.

The shop customers think Nigel is a gentleman, and they are always thankful for his help. Is this because Nigel happens to be the top cycle sales agent at the shop? Yes, but it's more than that. Nigel takes on all the aspects of his job with great care. The bike shop is a place filled with bikes, helmets, clothes, tires, tubes, and much more! These items must constantly be restocked. Special sale items must be moved to the

front of the store, and profits must be tracked. Nigel is always ready to attend to all of these tasks with a smile.

Nigel wants to find a way to engage customers even more, so he sets up a time to discuss this with his boss, Nancy. Nigel tells Nancy that he would like the shop to provide bike safety classes. It would be a great way to introduce their customers to the important elements of safe bike rides. Nancy is instantly thrilled about this concept. They work together to put a plan in place. There is only one problem. It will be necessary to have someone in command, and Nancy, as the bike shop owner, does not have time to take on any more work. So, who will run these classes?

Nigel and the Cisco Bike Shop PART TWO

The Cisco Bike Shop has to find someone to run its special safety classes. Nancy knows right away that Nigel is the only person for the job. He must work extra hours to produce a first-rate cycle safety program. Nigel accepts the new project. Then, he begins to outline all the components of the plan.

Before long, Nigel establishes the new bike safety program. The customers are impressed with the excellent classes he presents. The program is a huge success - except for one problem. The classes are very well-attended. Soon, it becomes necessary for the shop to hire more staff. Nancy reflects on how she will address this newest crisis.

Nancy calls the staff together for an important meeting. Nancy tells everyone about her plans to address the expanding role of the bike shop. She will hire five more salespeople, and she promotes Nigel to Director of Bike Safety Programs. Everyone claps and runs to hug Nigel. His years of especially intelligent cycle advice have paid off. It is likely that Nigel will become a bike shop legend!

Space Age Skit PART ONE

Students at the Belmont School were given a special task to prepare a skit, or quick play. It would be necessary for each class to write a scene and act it out on stage. The objective was for each five-minute skit to educate the other students about an important time in America's past.

One class chose to focus on the Space Age. They began by carefully checking the many books and websites published on this especially important topic. Each student had to contribute some of the text and provide their thoughts to develop an excellent onstage scene that focused on their selected theme.

Francis and Lucy were selected to handle the drafting of the actor's lines and the casting of the roles. The facts about the Space Age came in fast as the entire class worked attentively to produce a first-class project. They learned that the Space Age lasted for almost two decades from about 1957 to 1975. It had been a race to develop rockets, spacecrafts, and satellites to explore beyond planet Earth.

Americans and Russians spent those years establishing programs that attempted to put humans in space and even land on the moon. These methods were successful and, to this day, space programs across the world have made impressive progress.

Space Age Skit PART TWO

Francis and Lucy had to commit themselves to make sure that the class would be ready for the big day. They even worked during recess to ensure all the parts of this special project were on track.

Early on in the process, a student called Tracy was suggested for the top role. She was a shy student, but Francis and Lucy knew she was the best pick. Tracy was glad to be selected and she put in extra time during recess so she could prepare and study her lines.

When the big day came, Tracy's hands felt like icicles. For a moment, Tracy wished that someone would cancel the entire thing.

Francis and Lucy insisted that Tracy could do it. There was no time to replace her! Francis and Lucy gave her an especially big hug before she went on stage. In the end, Tracy said her lines without a trace of panic.

Offstage, Francis and Lucy looked on while the class acted out their Space Age skit with pride. The students in this class had accomplished a gigantic success! Even the principal of the school was impressed with the excellent job. It was then time to celebrate!

Stacy's Magic Act

Stacy walked onto the stage with an especially positive attitude and began her magic act. As she took her place at midstage, she addressed her classmates who had come to the school's talent contest. "I would like to introduce my able assistant, the Magnificent Vincent." With a puff of smoke, Stacy's pal, Vincent, instantly manifested on stage. Stacy's classmates were astonished! Her first trick was a huge success!

Stacy was positive that her next trick would be equally impressive. She wanted to make Vincent levitate. This trick was more difficult, but her classmates' excellent response to her first trick prompted Stacy to give it a try.

To do this, it was necessary to put Vincent into a daze. She requested that the students be very still. Then Stacy swung a gold object molded into the shape of a crescent in front of Vincent's face.

Once Vincent began to doze, Stacy spoke the magic word, "Abracadabra," and began to tap Vincent's bicep with her special baton – once, twice, thrice. Then, Vincent began to ascend a few inches off the stage! Stacy's classmates went wild with excitement!

Success with this trick was no accident. A lot of false test runs and a few hidden wires made this stunt look valid. Stacy was thrilled and felt that she would become a legend in all the school's talent contests!

Gem Theft PART ONE

The distress call came in to the Jackson City theft unit very early in the day. The caller requested that police detectives be sent right away to investigate the incident. The precinct detectives took the call and collected the necessary facts. The crime fell under their municipal role as protectors of the city, and they were, once again, ready to help.

It was commonplace for this kind of crime to take place at a fancy home, but this time the trespassing and theft happened at a secure warehouse. The warehouse had recently accepted a large shipment of fine gemstones. Some of these special stones were priceless and were to be sold to stores across America. Now, everything was gone!

The detectives learned that the warehouse had excellent methods in place to protect against this kind of thing. The entry was fully locked and especially thick. Secure glass had been installed to protect against trespassers, fire, theft, and accidents. And, to top it all off, skilled men and women were on staff to protect the warehouse and all its belongings 24 hours a day. So how did someone get in and take off with more than 50 boxes of opulent gemstones? That was the tragic riddle these detectives had to solve.

The detectives knew it was going to be difficult to solve this crime. They did not anticipate that it would be a cinch, but what happened next was something they didn't expect.

Gem Theft PART TWO

It is common to discuss an incident of grand theft with all the people close to the crime site. Witnesses can help solve these puzzles, sometimes in an instant. The police detectives were glad to learn that Danny, the warehouse boss, had already called in his entire staff. The detectives took a statement from every worker to ensure they didn't miss anything.

It was during these probes that the detectives got a break. They learned that Danny was the last one at the warehouse the evening before the theft. In fact, he had sent all the other workers home early. The detectives reflected on why that would have happened. Soon, there was a consensus. Danny knew more than he was saying!

Why was it necessary for him to send the staff home early? What did he see when he was alone in the warehouse? Could they deduce that, in fact, Danny was the culprit they were looking for?

As the detectives pulled Danny aside, it was evident that he had made some false statements. Danny was distrustful and confronted the detectives with a frigid stare. On the other hand, the detectives responded with a civil, yet unrelenting, inquest. They were especially skilled at getting suspects to confess. Could they elicit the truth out of Danny?

Yes! After many hours, Danny confessed to the entire disgraceful event. He thought he could become rich if he could just swipe the special gemstones. The detectives were able to close the case.

Secret Agent PART ONE

Cyrus is an intelligent and successful secret agent who is excellent at his job. He finds his work especially thrilling. Cyrus lives in a penthouse in the city of Los Angeles which is adjacent to the Pacific. However, his work often takes him to all parts of the world where he helps the local police investigate crimes that involve such things as secret quests, missing gemstones, celebrity scandals, and tragic accidents.

There are many stresses and risks that come with Cyrus' secret agent job, but he accepts this fact. He takes on all of his tasks with great tenacity - working to solve the most difficult riddles with strength and stamina.

There are plenty of incentives to this work as well. The agency compensates Cyrus quite nicely for his role. Cyrus makes a decent wage and he gets to use the most up-to-date equipment for his job. The device he likes the best is a special instrument that can help him access any entry his heart desires. He can make his way past any locked gate, opening, or blocked exit. Nothing is off limits!

Secret Agent PART TWO

Recently, Cyrus was put on a magnificent case working with other detectives to track down a missing Stone Age relic. The special stone instrument looks like just a chunk of rock, but, in fact, it is a priceless stone blade used by humans many thousands of years ago. It was taken from an exhibit by a bandit so crafty they even thought to replace the relic with a false one!

The disgraceful felon has been especially difficult to track down, so it has been necessary for Cyrus to diligently retrace all of the criminal's steps, follow up on all the tips, and develop an effective strategy to inspect all the data. But, Cyrus is up for the job! He will solve the crime!

The Prince of Wilson Castle PART ONE

A long time ago, there was a child prince whose name was James. He was the oldest son of King Henry and he lived with his family in the beautiful Wilson Castle. It had a thick stone wall and solid fence all around it to protect those inside.

To pass the time, James often spent his days up to no good. He constantly told jokes and invented new tricks to play on people. He would skip his math lessons so he could find the best spots to hide around the castle. Then, unexpectedly, he would jump out and scare his brother and sisters.

Some days, James would walk around the edge of the castle fence and collect rocks. He would then carefully arrange the rocks across the bridge which led

to the castle. James then hid behind a bench to look at all the visitors who would hop, skip, and lose their balance as they attempted not to stumble and fall on their way to the castle. Since the people crossing the bridge were never in any real danger, this trick made James giggle every time.

Finally, his family told James that his strange tricks and jokes had to stop. He was getting older now and someday he might even be king. It was necessary that he quickly begin to change his ways, follow the rules, and act more princely.

Was there a chance that James could put his silly tricks aside? Only time would tell.

The Prince of Wilson Castle PART TWO

Life in Wilson Castle could be a challenge at times. Candles had to be used to see at night. Drinkable water could be difficult to find, and the only way to keep the cold away was to arrange to be close to a fireplace. The castle, in fact, could be a strange and depressing place, especially without jokes.

James had to convince his father that he was trying his best to change and be more princely, and not make jokes. Hence, James spent his days going to his classes and finishing all of his chores.

Years passed and King Henry became very ill. He was restricted to his bed for many months. Who would rule the land in the king's absence? Was there evidence that Prince James was ready for this role?

James went in silence to his father's bedside.

With a quick glance, King Henry was aware of his son's presence and signaled for James to sit next to his bed. The king and his oldest son had a lot to discuss.

The king told James that he no longer had the strength to rule the kingdom. The throne would be passed down. The king reminded James that he would be fine if he trusted in his intelligence. James responded, "I guess I will just have to give it a try. Since I gave up all the jokes and tricks, I can take on this challenge, too! Will I be an excellent king like you?"

His father answered, "The people of the kingdom will be the judge of that."

The Dance Contest

While relaxing to some music, Constance saw a newsflash pop up on her laptop's homepage.

Contestants were wanted for a large dance contest in her city. The event would be happening next month, and Constance was instantly thrilled.

She had been going to dance lessons since she was five years old. Many people told her she was especially talented, but did she have a chance to win? Constance knew she had the necessary strength, balance, and range of skills, but she still had to convince herself to take a chance. There was no danger in trying!

Constance had to arrange her budget to finance the extra lessons, costumes, and entrance fee for the contest. Then she began to prepare two dance

programs just in case she made the final cut. She had to change the music several times. Everything had to be just right.

The day of the dance contest came at last. Constance suspected that she could advance and make the final cut. She confidently presented herself onstage dressed in an orange princess costume. After her entrance onto the stage, Constance took a quick glance at the guest judge. He was acting impressed already! The music began, and Constance felt like her mind was blank. She began to panic and made a small mistake. Lucky for Constance, the judge did not recognize the slipup. She finished her dance program, and the judge gave her excellent scores. She would be selected to advance to the finals!

Secrets of Stonehenge PART ONE

Stonehenge is a massive stone monument in Wiltshire, England. The ring of standing stones was constructed about 5,000 years ago, and it still fascinates guests from around the planet who visit it every year.

Who erected Stonehenge? How was Stonehenge constructed? What is the significance of Stonehenge? These are just some of the questions that have been a challenge for hundreds of years.

Probes into these riddles have suggested that more than 30 million hours would have been needed to move all of those gigantic stones to the site. The presence of two different kinds of stones has been found at Stonehenge. Some stones have a length of 30 feet and weigh 25 tons!

Some of these stones are sandstones and may have come from a distance of 20 miles away. Some of the smaller stones weigh up to 4 tons and likely came from over 100 miles away. It's a guess, but some think it would have been necessary to have 500 people just to move and arrange one of these stones. Stonehenge is an astonishing accomplishment when you think about it, but one has to ask why so many people would trudge miles and miles to construct this strange monument.

Secrets of Stonehenge PART TWO

Exactly how were the colossal stones that make up Stonehenge moved without the kind of equipment we have today? People speculate that these large stones could have been moved on a sledge using logs and ropes, despite the danger. Some especially inquisitive people have even attempted to replicate this difficult task to validate that it could be done with just human strength.

Why does Stonehenge exist? Many people have suggested that Stone Age humans may have traveled to Stonehenge looking for a cure for illness. Others have focused on the placement of the monument and the sun. One entrance lines up so the sunrise shines into

the depths of the monument on the summer solstice - the day in the year with the most sunlight. Is this just a coincidence?

Although there has been much debate about this strange site called Stonehenge, there is strong evidence that the landscape around Stonehenge was used as a sacred place to lay the dead to rest even before the stones were erected. The presence of human bones and new methods to investigate relics found at Stonehenge may help to divulge the stranger secrets of this special place.

The Remote Lodge

The Catskill Mountains can be found about two hours by car north of Manhattan. Lance and his friend, Midge, spend many days in this beautiful landscape each year. They find it extremely relaxing to get away from the hustle and bustle of the big city and spend some time fly fishing and going on long hikes. They have even done a little golfing while in the Catskills.

However, Lance and Midge are especially fond of one special spot. It's a small lodge on the edge of a glossy lake. They have to cross an old bridge and trudge down a dusty path to get to the remote lodge. Sure, they could check into a motel along the main road or stay in a fancy mountaintop hotel, but this rustic little lodge does the trick for Lance and Midge.

The shingles on the lodge are in need of some fixing, and the fence out front is somewhat unstable, but the tranquil silence is what they long for. No one is thought of as a stranger in this place. The owners of the lodge have been hosting one guest after another for more than twenty years.

The entrance to the lodge is made out of local hemlock, and out back there is a large deck that spans the entire length of the lodge. Lance and Midge think that it is an excellent spot to gaze at the sunset under an orange sky.

A Dolphin's Life PART ONE

Dolphins live in oceans stretching all across the planet. In fact, there are about 40 different kinds of dolphins in the world. These mammals are known for their extreme intelligence and their lively conduct. They are thought to have as much knowledge as apes.

Dolphins are part of the whale family, and they live in families called pods or schools. These schools can range from 2 to 30 depending on the kind of dolphin. A family of dolphins may develop because of a special bond such as a mother and her child. They will watch over each other and protect one another from physical danger.

Scientists have learned that a pod of dolphins will match up and hunt for food together, too. This phenomenon sometimes involves dolphins who arrange themselves in a line like a wall to trap and catch fish.

Dolphins get all the water they require directly from what they eat. You are most likely to catch them snacking on a batch of fish or jellyfish, but you may even find them munching on an octopus.

A Dolphin's Life PART TWO

Like other ocean mammals, dolphins must come up to the surface of the water to take air into their lungs. However, dolphins do not do this like humans do. They have special holes at the top of their heads to catch the air. This physical aspect helps to prevent dolphins from getting water into their lungs while they are hunting in the ocean.

Scientists who watch and study dolphins have learned that these ocean mammals can see very well in and out of the water. They can also hear things at a pitch, or frequency, that humans cannot. Strangely though, dolphins have no sense of smell.

The greatest enemy to a dolphin is a human. People ditch their trash and pollute ocean waters across the planet. Careless hunting and fishing methods can be destructive to ocean mammals as well. These acts impact the life of a dolphin in a negative way. But, it's not too late for humans to switch our ways. We can stop this carelessness. We can all work together to emphasize how important it is to save these graceful and intelligent animals.

The Online Science Class PART ONE

As Ralph scratches his chin and stretches his legs, he restlessly stares at his laptop. He has been awake since six a.m. to watch for the post about the new online science class project. Ralph intends to begin the work right away. He has plans to attend college in a few years, so he must do his best in each class he takes.

Ralph rechecks all the switches and adjusts the volume on his laptop. He should hear a sound when the post goes live, so he makes a quick run to the kitchen to grab a snack. As he walks back to his laptop, Ralph thinks, “How long will this take?”

Ding! Finally, his instructor posts the project with an apology at the end for its lateness.

Ralph looks through the lesson statement and learns that his instructor is asking that each student investigate a wild animal. The students will have twenty days to explore a topic, write down all the facts, then use their notes to compose a scientific booklet focusing on the knowledge they collect. Each student must put their final copy up on the class website within the twenty-day time frame. Ralph hatches a plan to tackle this project.

First, Ralph must pitch his concept to the instructor. Once the topic is accepted, the rest of the work can begin. Ralph knows right away what animal he wants to write about. He thinks to himself, “Why not write about a big animal. In fact, why not study the biggest land animal on Earth?”

The Online Science Class PART TWO

Ralph logs into the class website. Then, he adds his notes about the specific animal he would like to explore. While he is still online, Ralph gets an answer. His instructor says, “Yes.” Ralph is all set to study the African elephant.

Before Ralph clicks to close the class website page, he finds a special note. It suggests that, if possible, the students try to spend time watching their selected animal live in person. Ralph wants to do his best with this project, but struggles to think of a way to arrange a day with an African elephant! It’s a problem to solve another time.

Ralph begins his work by fetching as many facts as possible about this impressive mammal. He learns

many things about the life and the physical aspects of the African elephant. Soon, his knowledge about this animal with a trunk is expanding. He writes it all down in his notebook. Then he drafts his scientific booklet with three parts: physical aspects of the animal, where they live, and the fate of elephants on Earth. On the last page, Ralph adds a graph that represents the elephants' decline on the planet.

The cutoff date to post the final draft of the project is still five days away. Ralph will have plenty of time to check his work and make any adjustments before his instructor takes a look. He is confident thanks to the careful work he has done.

The First Telephone Call

What do you do when you want to talk with someone who lives in another city? Yes, you just pick up your phone and make a call. However, this was not always the case.

In 1837, the telegraph was invented. This made it possible to send a clicking signal across a wire. After that, it did not take long to produce a way to transmit these physical signals through cables. These cables soon stretched all across America. Before long, the clicking signals were matched to the alphabet. Having knowledge of this code made it possible to communicate with people anywhere telegraph lines existed.

However, one intelligent man in Boston wished for something greater. Alexander Graham Bell wanted to advance the telegraph.

His scientific work focused on developing a way to transmit more than one telegram at a time. He wanted to show that you could send notes and signals with different pitches.

Mr. Bell worked tirelessly. One day, by accident, his assistant sent a sound across a wire. This shocking moment in 1875 expanded Bell's work. By the next year, he had invented a way to talk to another person across a wire. The first telephone call made between Bell and his assistant would change everything!

An African Elephant Haven PART ONE

Ralph could go the extra mile with his college science class project if he could just find a way to inspect an African elephant himself. He had been reflecting on how he could make this happen for days. The prime glitch was that going to Africa was impossible. Ralph was about to give up on his quest when he made an astonishing find on his laptop. Hopeful, he clicked on the website.

With a stroke of luck, there was an African elephant haven, a place of safety, less than two hours away from his home in Memphis. Who knew? Ralph would be able to witness an African elephant firsthand. This was the best news ever!

Ralph made arrangements to take a bus to the haven. The dispatcher said to be at the bus stop early the next day. Ralph found his satchel, a small bag he used for day trips. Then he fetched a pen and sketchpad to take notes and his cellphone to take some photos.

Ralph made it to the African elephant haven the next day without a hitch. He had to switch buses at one stop, but he was still able to spend most of the day as a guest at the haven. As he collected facts and photos, Ralph's knowledge of these massive land mammals expanded greatly.

An African Elephant Haven PART TWO

The African elephant haven was home to six captive elephants. Ralph was shocked to find out that they were over ten feet tall. He learned that their gigantic tusks and trunks were used for a wide range of tasks. Ralph was thrilled to watch them move with such strength and gracefulness.

Ralph was told that, in the past, these elephants had spent their days in a circus or a zoo. It was common knowledge that these animals tended to have physical and other problems because they had not spent their lives in the wild.

The haven's objective was to safely provide the special care these elephants demanded when they switched into this new phase of life called retirement. It was an atmosphere with an emphasis on refuge, not danger, for these majestic beings.

Ralph ended his day pleased that he had gotten the chance to watch these African elephants up close. He left the haven with a sketchpad full of notes and over fifty photographs in his phone. Ralph intended to visit the haven again - no science class project necessary!

The Bottlenose Dolphin PART ONE

The bottlenose dolphin is a specific kind of dolphin. It lives in the oceans of the tropics and other spots that are not too cold. However, if this dolphin happens to make a switch and swim into water that is a bit colder, it will not be in danger. This is thanks to the thick band of fat they have under their skin. The fat helps them resist the cold.

If you have some knowledge about the physical aspects of this animal, it can be quite simple to spot a bottlenose. Its mouth has an angle at the end which makes it look like the dolphin always has a friendly smile on its face. The nose is little and thick, hence the name bottlenose. A large fin can be found on the middle of its back. The tail at the end of its body is

made up of two flukes, or lobes. Some bottlenose dolphins have belly blotches, or spots.

If you were to hitch a ride with a bottlenose, you could be on a swim of up to 20 miles per hour. You could find yourself tossed out of the water up to 16 feet then crash back down with a huge splash.

Like other dolphins, the bottlenose lives in a family-like setting called a pod or school. Scientists have witnessed these pods of dolphins match up and work together to hunt for food. They strive to catch a glimpse of this collective act and witness how, working together, the dolphins optimize hunting. The result - a large catch of fish!

The Bottlenose Dolphin PART TWO

Bottlenose dolphins are extremely intelligent. Scientists have even learned that they can communicate with other dolphins. Each bottlenose dolphin develops a special whistle that provides the ability for one dolphin to recognize another. They can also mimic, or match, another dolphin's whistle.

Dolphins like the bottlenose have also developed a special way to “see” sound. This still baffles those in the scientific world. Dolphins are able to catch and translate an echo of a sound wave as it bumps off an object close by them in the water. To locate these objects, dolphins produce high-frequency clicks. The sound waves from these clicks stretch quickly through the water around them. When sound waves bump off an object close by, the dolphin can detect many basic

physical aspects such as shape or size. This is helpful when they are hunting for food and must navigate around in pitch-black waters.

Bottlenose dolphins were once widely hunted. However, today they are more likely to be killed when they get stuck in a net or other fishing equipment. Scientists have been quick to share their knowledge about specific dangers that can affect the bottlenose dolphin. Toxic waste, the melting of icecaps, and a rise in ocean levels are all examples of problems that impact the water habitat of dolphins. It will be wise for humans to carefully watch how our conduct benefits or distresses the lives of these special ocean animals.

The Wildlife Refuge

Joseph Mitchell is a Dutch scientific photographer at a wildlife refuge in Africa. His job involves photographing the many animals that live there. The physical aspect of his job can be demanding as these animals live on a massive span of land that stretches hundreds of miles.

Joseph's photo subjects include African foxes, jackals, buffalo, and ostriches. However, Joseph loves to take photos of elephants, zebras, and snakes most of all. The elephants are regal and majestic. The zebras, with their magnificent stripes, can be difficult to catch on film as they quickly run through the long, dry grass. It's common knowledge that Africa is home to many of the world's most lethal snakes. Therefore,

Joseph makes sure to stand a good distance away when photographing those reptiles!

Joseph uses a telephoto lens to spot animals in the vicinity from a safe distance. Then he travels in his truck to get as close as he can to watch them. Joseph has the ability catch the most fantastic moments on film. He is able to emphasize how beautiful each animal is in its African habitat.

One specific photo Joseph took won an impressive prize. It was a photograph of a baby ostrich hatching from its shell. The photo bewitched both the public and the contest judge! Joseph won a lot of cash and exhibited that his photography talents are unmatched.

The New Kitten

Peg and Mike had wanted to adopt a kitten for a long time. Their children had left for college so they had the whole house to themselves.

Peg and Mike filled out the online application questions for the adoption of a new kitten. After five days, they learned that their application was accepted. The next step was to visit the local animal humane institution. This is where they would be able to get a kitten.

When Peg and Mike called to select a date and time, they found out the next opening was three days away. To help pass the time, they made a list of things to get to help with the shift to becoming pet owners. Then, they took their list to the store.

The saleslady at the shop had a lot of great recommendations. They took the lady's suggestions and bought a box of food, a cat bed, a scratching post, and a collection of a few other necessary items.

Finally, the adoption day came. First, they met with the vet on staff and had a half-hour discussion about the basics of cat care. Then it was time for the introductions. Peg was full of emotion as the small cage was lifted onto the table. Out came a tiny black and white kitten. He shyly walked over to Peg and with gentle hands, she picked him up. The kitten began to cuddle. This was exactly what Peg had envisioned. Peg and Mike would be able to provide a special kitten a new home and, in exchange, they would get some attention and love.

Mr. Vincent's Class Celebration

Mr. Vincent wants to plan a celebration for his whole class of first-grade students. It will be a special occasion for the end of the school year!

The students have come a long way since the first day of school. Back then, half of the students did not use capitalization in their compositions. Today, they know to use a capital for the first word in a sentence and with a specific name, place, or thing. The students have finished hundreds of books in total, putting their well-developed reading skills to the test.

On top of all of that, the students have their addition and subtraction facts down pat in math. They are also good at communication, active discussions, asking questions that make sense, and using their

imaginations to solve tricky problems. Mr. Vincent is so pleased with their progress and, best of all, the kids are pleased with themselves.

For the big celebration, Mr. Vincent will get a bunch of decorations, vanilla cupcakes, and plenty of drinks. He plans to have music, crafts, and games as well. Mr. Vincent is envisioning a great time for all!

Mr. Vincent thinks that one student's suggestion to extend invitations to the school administration and the students' families is great. He hopes the celebration will be a hit with all who attend. He is so glad that he will be able to demonstrate to his students how accomplished they are before they set off on vacation - and then on to second grade!

The Inca Civilization

Hundreds of years ago, over 2,000 miles of roads were built that stretched along the Pacific shores of South America. To whom do we give the credit for this connection of roads? The Inca civilization, that's who!

The people of the Inca civilization were especially skilled at other things too. They could craft a bridge, a tunnel, or even a whole city. They could work with cloth, stone, and all kinds of metals. These talents led to the evolution of a massive kingdom. The Inca had special traditions. They had skill with math computations. And, they had great drive which led to many successes during their rule.

The Inca people planted many crops. In addition, these wise people could cure themselves of sickness long before medical science existed. Conditions such as physical illnesses and problems with emotions were addressed by the Inca in their own special ways.

The Inca people did not write down their legends like ourselves. However, mothers and fathers still passed along their collection of tales and traditions. They retold them to their children.

There is no question that the Inca was a nation of people with many skills. We may find ourselves thinking about contributions of the Inca for a long time.

The Invention of the Television PART ONE

Televisions can be found in homes all across the world, but that was not always the case.

The first kind of television invented was primitive. One of these gadgets sent pictures through wires and the rotation of a metal disk. The inventors themselves called it an electric telescope, and it was nothing like the televisions we have today. However, these early TVs led the way for the next wave of inventors whose contraptions would be called electronic televisions.

To whom do we credit the invention of the first electronic television? The answer to that question can be difficult to fathom.

The person who accomplished this great advancement in 1927 was only 21 years old! His last name was Farnsworth. He lived in a house that did not even have electricity until he was 14 years old.

The Invention of the Television PART TWO

As a student, Farnsworth began to try to come up with a way to catch pictures that move, change them to code, then move them to another device. His method used electrons to transmit the pictures. Farnsworth was not the first person to think about doing this, but he was the first person to make it work. There was instant recognition that, with this new invention, he was on to something big. In fact, by the 1930s, all televisions had been switched to the electronic method.

Before anyone knew it, the world's first national television stations began to pop up. Then, more and more advancements with this fun device followed.

The first remote control that could change a channel or shut the TV off came along in 1955. During this same time, color TVs were on the rise. Today, we take this for granted. When is the last time you watched a black and white TV?

Now we have many options when looking to own a television. You can get one in any shape or size that you desire. We also find ourselves face to face with the temptation of online television and other innovations. Will these newest evolutions result in the extinction of the television as we know it? Only time will tell!

A Position with Judge Phillips

Ginny filled out the long application for a job with Judge Phillips. Judge Phillips was a magistrate judge whose job was to handle each criminal or civil case with integrity. Ginny felt that working for this judge would give her the chance to do some important work.

Ginny knew there were many applications landing on Judge Phillips' desk. She reflected on how she might get hers to the top of the pile. Then, it hit her. She had half a mind to introduce herself to the judge to get an edge in the process.

Ginny found out that a reception was to be held at the city hall and the judge would be attending. Ginny made plans to go and make a face-to-face introduction. She would then be able to mention to the judge that she was an applicant for the open position.

Although she did not wish to be an imposition on the judge, Ginny had the strong intention of bumping into her at the reception. At last, Ginny saw the judge standing alone. This was her one chance. Ginny went up to the judge and extended her hand. The judge was friendly and impressed with Ginny's motivation.

The next day, Ginny got a call from the judge whom she had met in person the evening before. The judge had been struck by Ginny's passion for the constitution. She made the suggestion that Ginny set up a time to connect with her once again. Things were looking good for Ginny's application!

The Clock that Couldn't Tell Time PART ONE

The large grandfather clock sits against the wall next to the front entrance as usual. It's been there for a long time and has been passed down time and time again to somebody in the Griffin family for over 200 years. The clock is stately with its maple panels, brass hands, and fancy glass doors. There's just one problem - it doesn't work!

The present-day owner of the clock, Conrad Griffin, thinks to himself, "What's the use of having a grand clock if it can't tell you the time?" He commits to find a way to fix this sad clock once and for all.

Conrad knows neither the cause of the problem nor how long it's been unable to tell time, but he's aware that he probably won't be able to fix the clock himself. So, he does a quick look online. He finds a website that belongs to Mrs. Sullivan. She describes herself as the "supreme fixer of clocks." Conrad says to himself, "We'll see about that!"

Even though he's unsure about Mrs. Sullivan's skills, Conrad wastes no time and calls her right away. She's quick to take the call and makes plans with Conrad to go to his house to take a look at the old family clock.

The Clock that Couldn't Tell Time PART TWO

When Mrs. Sullivan comes to the house the next day, Conrad takes her to the clock and she's quick to get right to work. And wouldn't you know, Mrs. Sullivan has the clock back to working status in under 30 minutes. Conrad is shocked!

Mrs. Sullivan tells Conrad that it's a simple fix in the end. She asks Conrad if the clock has ever been moved. Conrad responds, "Well, yes. In fact, it's probably been moved ten times over the past several decades."

Mrs. Sullivan says, "That's the problem. Even though grandfather clocks are long-lasting instruments, they'll usually stop working after being moved. The problem in this case is that the clock's leveling was off. This can

cause a grandfather clock to stop telling time. There are four adjustable levelers on the bottom of the clock. Once somebody readjusts them, the clock works just like it's new."

Conrad thanks Mrs. Sullivan and takes care of the bill. He's happy to know that there's somebody dependable out there to help fix these old clocks. He's also pleased that Mrs. Sullivan's website is right - she is the "supreme fixer of clocks"!

With the grandfather clock in a working state, Conrad's glad to know that when he passes it on to somebody else in the Griffin family, it will look beautiful and, more importantly, it will tell the time!

A Lonely Fish

Meg's fish, Ralph, was positioned at the bottom of the large fish tank. The orange and white fish barely moved, and it was evident that he wasn't doing well. Usually, Ralph was quite active and would swim to either side of the tank many times each day. However, during the last two days, Ralph's body was mostly still, and he hadn't snacked on his fish food like he usually does.

Meg fed him a new kind of fish food, but he wasn't having any of it! She made sure she disinfected the tank and refilled it with fresh water, but that didn't do the trick either. "What could be stressing Ralph so much?" Meg asked herself.

Things went on this way for a while. Then one day, Meg found a story in a local publication about how fish can, in fact, get depressed. When this happens to fish, it's usually because they're lonely.

“That’s it!” thought Meg. “Ralph is probably sad because he’s all alone in that big tank.” So, Meg made her way to the local pet store. With the help of the shop owner, Meg picked out a fish. It was gold with black stripes.

When she got home, Meg put the new fish in the tank. Ralph swam right up to his new fish friend and he was a lonely fish no more.

The Vast Pacific

You're probably aware that there are five large oceans on Earth, but did you know that the Pacific tops the list when it comes to size? In fact, this vast ocean stretches across almost one-third of the entire planet. That's more than all the land found on Earth!

Many nations have shores along the Pacific. These nations include Mexico, the U.S.A, Canada, Japan, and China. The name Pacific comes from the Latin word "pace" which translates to "peace." Many people have set their ships across the Pacific waves to explore it. However, people couldn't find a way to get to the immense Pacific Ocean from the Atlantic until a man called Magellan accomplished this around 500 years ago.

The Pacific's waters are home to more than 25,000 islands, most of the world's volcanoes, and an endless

number of ocean plants and animals. Tropical fish, dolphins, gigantic squid, and humpback whales are some of the animals that call the Pacific their home.

Today, the Pacific makes important contributions to the world's economy. The rich waters of the Pacific make it a great spot for either fishing or collecting other ocean goods. There are tuna, halibut, sole, and many different kinds of shellfish in this lush ocean. But, that's not all. You'll also find that in the Pacific, oil, gas, sand, and gravel are abundant.

There's no question that the Pacific Ocean is a magnificent place. You're sure to be astonished by its majestic size and endless assets. What else is there to know about this impressive body of water? That can be answered by anybody willing to explore!

Cyrus Skips the Shore

When Cyrus finds out his friends are spending the day at the shore, he's sad. He's tempted to cancel his shift at work so he can go to the ocean too. However, everybody knows that's probably not what Cyrus will do. That's because Cyrus is working to save money to get a new truck. Cyrus reminds himself that he doesn't want to keep walking everywhere or have to ask somebody else for a ride. He won't give up his shift at work just for one day of fun.

As his friends travel to the shore, Cyrus walks to the fish shop where he sells fish to customers who are often either cranky or in a rush. It's messy work and at the end of a shift, he's usually spent. Cyrus lugs around massive crates of shrimp, clams, scallops,

and mussels. Cyrus then sets fish in a case packed with lots of ice. This ice keeps the fish cold and fresh. There's nothing more disgusting than fish gone bad. It stinks and it can make people sick if somebody were to ingest it!

At the end of his shift, Cyrus drags himself home. He anticipates a bath to get the fishy stench off his body. As he walks, Cyrus thinks about the fun everybody else probably had at the shore today. But quickly, Cyrus reminds himself about the cash he made for that new truck. A smile comes to his face because he's sure that he'd made the right decision.

Ice Rink Mix-Up

Melinda has been on ice skates since she was little. After ten years of focused lessons, her diligence and motivation have paid off! Melinda executes her spins with elegance. She positions her body during her jumps so they're done in a consistent and polished way. She's now at the top of her craft.

Melinda has a national competition coming up with only two more months to prepare. She must learn a new jump sequence and expand her spin moves to impress the judges. They can be strict at these national events, and they have explicitly said that they don't want to look at the same old thing.

Melinda and her coach make it to the rink for their usual session time of six a.m. Once they're

inside, they witness that the rink is being used by somebody else. There's an instructor in the middle of the ice with students who are just learning how to skate. Melinda's coach declares, "What's going on? There's got to be a mix-up! I booked this time for us. I'll go talk to the owner."

The owner of the rink confesses that he's probably made a mistake. He is quick to sincerely apologize for the mix-up and confusion. He tells Melinda's coach that he'll resolve the problem by readjusting the times for the lessons from here on out. Melinda is glad to know that she'll be able to get ready for the upcoming competition after all. But today, she'll get an unexpected day off!